Tally Charts & Frequency Tables

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Tally charts & frequency tables

What is a tally chart?

- **Tally charts** are a quick way to **count** data
- Each time you count an item, draw a vertical line
  - Do this the **first four** times
  - The **fifth time**, draw a **diagonal line** through the four vertical lines 卌
  - Continue counting in **sets of five**
- For example
  - Counting different coloured flowers in the garden

Colour	Tally
Blue	卌
Red	卌 卌 ||
Yellow	|||

What is a frequency table?

- A **frequency** table counts **how many times** an item appears
- **Tally charts** can be converted into frequency tables
  - Find the **totals**
    - Count up in 5's then add any extras
    - 卌 卌 \|\| means 5 + 5 + 2 = 12
- The tally chart above gives the following frequency table:

Colour	Frequency
Blue	5
Red	12

Help me understand

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it

Worked Example

Susie asks pupils in her class to select their favourite type of pet.

Write the results in a frequency table.

Dog	Cat	Dog	Dog	Dog
Rabbit	Dog	Rabbit	Cat	Cat
Cat	Dog	Dog	Rabbit	Dog
Cat	Cat	Dog	Dog	Dog

Answer:

It helps to use a tally chart initially

Type of pet	Tally
Dog	𝍸 𝍸 |
Cat	𝍸 |
Rabbit	|||

Then write the tally chart as a frequency table

Type of pet	Frequency
Dog	11
Cat	6
Rabbit	3

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